VILLANOVA UNIVERSITY
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTING SCIENCES

University Honors Program
Villanova University
800 Lancaster Avenue
Villanova, PA 19085

October 7, 2026

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for an adjunct faculty position in Villanova's Honors Program to teach a new one-credit course, *Performing Magic*. I was an Associate Professor in Villanova's Department of Computing Sciences from 2002 to 2025, when I retired from full-time teaching to pursue work on my online, interactive textbook, software design, continuing research, and my career as a professional magician.

After discussing my idea for a course with Honors instructor J-P Spiro, as his encouragement I presented the proposal to Anna Moreland, who approved the development of a one-credit course titled *Performing Magic*. I am now seeking formal appointment as an adjunct faculty member to teach the course.

Performing Magic combines my decades of experience as a professional magician with my background as a university educator. The course treats magic both as a performing art and as a subject of intellectual inquiry, giving students hands-on experience learning techniques, developing stage presence, constructing routines, and performing for an audience while exploring the psychology, neuroscience, philosophy, history, and performance theory underlying magic. Students will examine how magicians shape perception, direct attention, construct meaning, and create experiences of wonder and belief, as well as the role of deception within a theatrical context. Through practice, performance, analysis, and reflection, the course integrates the technical, creative, and intellectual dimensions of magic, giving students an unusual opportunity to explore human perception and behavior through an art form they can learn to perform themselves.

I am excited by the opportunity to return to Villanova in a new capacity and to combine two longstanding parts of my professional life, higher education and magic, in a course that I believe can be both intellectually engaging and genuinely fun for students.

Sincerely,

Thomas P. Way

Dr. Thomas P. Way
Associate Professor Emeritus
Department of Computing Sciences